

INSTANT REPLAY...

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star who signed with the New York Yankees. He rose to AAA baseball with Denver in the American Association and once, starting against Charleston, he walked the first five men to face him. John Blanchard, later a star receiver for the Yankees, was catching and he called time, walked to the mound, and said: "Hey, Freeman, if the fix is on, let me in on it."

When Rogers Hornsby was in his prime he was hitting against a rookie pitcher whose first two tosses were called balls by the umpire Bill Klem. The hurler complained about both of them, but Mr. Klem ignored him. On the third pitch, Hornsby laced it into left center and as he was rounding first, heading for second, Mr. Klem stalked in front of the plate and hollered to the dejected pitcher: "When it's a strike, Mr. Hornsby will let you know."

Somebody once asked Charlie McClendon what was the best pass defense. Cholly Mac, without a moment's hesitation replied: "a four touchdown lead."

A few years ago Buddy Blair, the former LSU star and Hall of Fame member, managed the Alexandria Aces. His team blew a seven run lead in the last inning and Buddy was beside himself. Finally, he called Salty Parker, then managing the parent Shreveport team, itself a cellar occupant, and said "Salty, what do you do when you have a seven run lead in the ninth inning and can't hold it?"

"Don't ask me," Parker wearily replied, "I've never had a seven run lead."

Speaking of blowing leads, in 1960, the first year of the American Football League, games were high scoring affairs. Buffalo led Denver 38-7 with four minutes left in the third quarter when the Broncos suddenly got hot and the game ended in a 38-38 tie. Buster Ramsey, coaching the Bills, was riding to the airport in a cab with a sports writer who asked him how he took a game like that.

"You don't worry about it," said Buster. "You forget about it. There's nothing you can do about it after it's over, you just look ahead to next week."

As he was talking he was pouring a shot of booze from a bottle, aiming for a paper cup in his other hand, but missing and dumping the liquid into his lap!

Andy Cohen was a likeable sort who managed a number of minor league teams after his playing career ended. However, Andy recalled a favorite story which happened back in the days when he was with the old New York Giants who were managed by the legendary Muggsy McGraw. Once playing a game in Irish-dominated Boston, Freddie Fitzsimmons, pitching for the Giants, was lifted for a pinch hitter who happened to be Cohen. The public address announcer intoned: "Cohen now batting for Fitzsimmons."

With that a red-faced immigrant from Ireland stood up behind the dugout and at the top of his lungs, yelled: "And Harrigan now leaving the ball park!"

Remember the time a football coach, at the opening of fall practice held a pigskin aloft and said to his assembled hopefuls: "Now, men, this is a football."

From the back of the room came the plaintive plea: "Not so fast, coach."

Or the time the two professional basketball players were waiting for a game in the locker room when one of them said: "I have an awful time remembering names."

The other said: "Me, too, until I took that Sam Carnegie course."